

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM



Texas Democrats talk at the DuPage County Democratic Party headquarters in Carol Stream on Sunday after leaving their state to deny state Republicans the quorum they need to redraw five congressional districts. **BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Texas Dems urge blue states to redraw congressional lines

Party's House leader dismisses Abbott's threats to file felony bribery charges

By Rick Pearson, Jeremy Gorner and Olivia Olander
Chicago Tribune

On their first full day in Illinois and other northern states, Texas House Democrats who fled their home state to block a Republican-led midterm congressional redistricting plan on Monday encouraged leaders in Democratic states to actively look at redrawing their own boundaries and abandon the national party's long-standing support for politically fair maps to counter partisan gerrymandering.

State Rep. Gene Wu of Houston, leader

of the Democratic minority in the Texas House, also dismissed Texas Republican Gov. Greg Abbott's threats against the House Democrats, which include the governor saying he'd seek their removal from office or the filing of felony bribery charges for leaving the state on Sunday to prevent Republicans from advancing their new map.

"Frankly, Democrats say, 'Come and take it,'" Wu said, directing his comments to Abbott and the majority Republicans, while appearing on CNN from Chicago. The historic Texas fighting phrase comes from the 1835 launch of the Texas Revolu-

tion against Mexico. "It's all bluster, sound and fury, signifying nothing."

The call to action by Texas Democrats for Democratic-led states to redraw their boundaries follows the currently stymied effort by Abbott and Texas Republicans who offered a map that could flip five districts to the GOP in 2026 in an effort to sustain what is a narrow Republican U.S. House majority in Washington, D.C., to assist Trump in the final two years of his second presidential term.

The Texas House met at 3 p.m. Monday

Turn to Texas, Page 4

Videos of hostages horrify Israelis

Images released by militant groups add to ceasefire pressure

By Melanie Lidman
Associated Press

JERUSALEM — New images of emaciated Israeli hostages held in Gaza have horrified Israelis and added pressure on Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu to reach a ceasefire with Hamas, even as his government considers another expansion of the nearly 22-month war.

The videos released late last week by militant groups Hamas and Palestinian Islamic Jihad show two skeletal hostages pleading for their lives. In one, Eyyatar David says he is digging his own grave and speaks of days without food. In the other, Rom Braslavski writhes in agony on a dirty mattress and says injuries in his foot prevent him from being able to stand.

The Associated Press does not normally publish videos of hostages filmed under duress but is publishing brief excerpts after receiving consent from their families.

The videos led tens of thousands of Israelis to take to the streets on Saturday night and demand a ceasefire deal, in one of the largest turnouts for the weekly protests in recent months.

"You see your child dying before your eyes, and you can't do anything," said Ofir Braslavski, Rom's father, on Monday from his home. "It drives you crazy, it's unbearable, there's nothing you can do."

Braslavski said Rom looks much worse than he did in a video the militants released of him four months ago.

"There, he also looks terrible, but he had this hope in his eyes where he felt he

Turn to Hostages, Page 8

As the last baby boomers retire, they tackle a quest for fulfillment

By Sophie Levenson
Chicago Tribune

Forty-two stories above ground, Jon Gottlieb traced his bicycle route. From his vantage point by the pool, on his building's roof, he could see the stop sign where he turns right, the road he hates crossing, the park he rides through and the tunnel that leads to the Lake-front Trail bike path.

Gottlieb, 75, rode this route at least five times a week through the 13 years since he moved into the Lincoln Park building, the tail end of a five-decade commitment to cycling. For half a century, the retired railroad services manager tracked his mileage on bicycles and compiled it in a spreadsheet. Mark Mattei, who serviced Gottlieb's bikes for 36 years, said it was clear that Gottlieb was honest about his mileage.

In 2020, he passed 100,000 miles on his bike. In 2023, he hit 110,000. Last week, Gottlieb prepared for two-wheel retire-

ment as he geared up to ride his 115,000th mile. He reached his final threshold Friday.

"You gotta quit somewhere," he said.

With his serious cycling days behind him, Gottlieb faces a life unstructured by a goal. He's retired, happily married and financially comfortable. But like others on the older side of the baby boomer generation, he's not quite sure how to spend his days without reaching toward something.

Some experts say that Americans tend to identify themselves with their careers, which leaves them feeling lost in retirement. Others, though, have found that baby boomers, especially the younger ones, are much better at finding fulfillment outside work than their parents were. As the last of the baby boomers reach retirement age, they have to manage more than financial stability — they're figuring out what fulfillment looks like.

Turn to Retire, Page 4



Saman Khan, center, a postdoctoral fellow, conducts research on lymphatics in health and disease using animal models at the Simpson & Kimberly Querrey Biomedical Center on Northwestern University's medical campus on Monday. **EILEEN T. MESLAR/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Funding cuts ripple across NU

Faculty, staff warn situation dire: 'Time is running out'

By Kate Armanini
Chicago Tribune

Nearly four months have passed since the Donald Trump administration abruptly froze \$790 million in federal funding at Northwestern University, and the school's fragile research infrastructure has been pummeled by cuts.

Portions of research and clinical trials have ground to a halt. Labs have been

instructed to scrutinize every expense, from equipment to personnel. Some teams are even killing off lab mice because it's cheaper than feeding them and cleaning cages.

With university President Michael Schill set to appear again before a congressional committee Tuesday, rumors of a possible deal with the White House have gripped campus. But the situation on-the-ground remains dire, according to faculty and staff.

"Let's say they unfreeze the funds. The

Turn to Funding, Page 2

Naperville sees increase in DUI arrests

Naperville police made 258 drunken driving arrests in 2024, a 51.8% increase over the 170 made in 2023. The number put the city at No. 4 on the list of top 10 municipalities with the most DUI arrests. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

Window to show interest in Bally's IPO closing

Bally's Chicago closed its online portal Monday at noon, ending the opportunity for potential investors to indicate interest in the \$250 million IPO and perhaps own a piece of the city's first casino. **Business**

TODAY'S WEATHER



High **84** Low **68**

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 18

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